

Tarek Mahmoud

PRINCIPAL DATA SCIENTIST · NLP · LLMS · AGENTIC AI · PRESIGHT AT G42

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Summary

Principal Data Scientist at Presight, G42, with 7+ years of production experience building and deploying AI systems across government, finance, public health, and behavioral analytics. Specializes in agentic AI, generative AI, retrieval-augmented generation, NLP, and large-scale analytics, working across client delivery, product development, and applied R&D to translate complex requirements into production systems. PhD in NLP from MBZUAI, with research spanning persuasion, psycholinguistics, computational social science, and multilingual NLP.

Professional Experience

INDUSTRY

2023–present **Principal Data Scientist**, Presight (G42 Group), Abu Dhabi, UAE

2021–2023 **Senior Data Scientist**, Presight (G42 Group), Abu Dhabi, UAE

2019–2021 **Data Scientist (Founding Team)**, Presight (G42 Group), Abu Dhabi, UAE

- Designed and delivered client-facing AI systems across government, finance, public health, and behavioral analytics, collaborating across data engineering, MLOps, software engineering, product, and business teams to translate complex requirements into production systems and reusable AI capabilities.
- Architected and built agentic AI, investment intelligence, automated analytical reporting, and law-enforcement AI capabilities across professional services, product development, and applied R&D.
- Developed an Azure-based real-time multilingual speech translation system integrating ASR, machine translation, speaker diarization, and TTS for live multilingual events and meeting intelligence.
- Provided technical input to senior leadership on AI architecture, technology evaluation, vendor selection, due diligence, and technical planning.
- Mentored interns and selected program participants through applied data-science projects, providing hands-on technical guidance and project supervision.
- Built, deployed, and maintained production NLP, computer-vision, knowledge-graph, and large-scale data-processing systems across cloud environments and heterogeneous structured and unstructured data.
- Designed and implemented data-science capabilities supporting a national COVID-19 response, including forecasting, epidemic simulation, contact tracing, risk profiling, and vaccine prioritization.

2018 **Machine Learning Engineer (Internship)**, Aramco, Dhahran, KSA

RESEARCH

2022–2026 **Graduate Research Assistant**, MBZUAI, Abu Dhabi, UAE

- Published 15+ papers at ACL, EACL, NAACL, and EMNLP venues; 700+ citations, h-index 9.
- Co-organized three SemEval/GenAIDetect shared tasks on machine-generated text detection and narrative extraction.

2016–2019 **Graduate Research Assistant**, KAUST, Thuwal, KSA

2015 **Research Intern**, KAUST (Visual Computing Center), Thuwal, KSA

2012–2016 **Undergraduate Research Assistant**, KFUPM, Dhahran, KSA

TEACHING

- 2023–2025 **VIP Mentor**, G42 Special Programs, Abu Dhabi, UAE — nominated to deliver tailored AI mentorship to VIP participants on topics covering generative AI, big data analytics, and cloud computing.
- 2025 **Teaching Assistant**, MBZUAI Research Internship Program, Abu Dhabi, UAE — mentored summer research interns, resulting in the FRaN-X demo paper
- 2024 **Teaching Assistant**, MBZUAI Research Internship Program, Abu Dhabi, UAE — mentored summer research interns, resulting in the EACL 2024 FRAPPE demo paper
- 2023–2025 **Teaching Assistant**, MBZUAI (Graduate NLP Course), Abu Dhabi, UAE
- 2018 **Teaching Assistant**, KAUST (Graduate ML Course), Thuwal, KSA

Education

Mohamed Bin Zayed University of Artificial Intelligence (MBZUAI)

Abu Dhabi, UAE

PHD IN COMPUTER SCIENCE, NATURAL LANGUAGE PROCESSING

2022 – 2026

- Dissertation: [Modeling Persuasion in Language](#)
- Research Focus: Psycholinguistics, cognitive computing, computational social science

King Abdullah University of Science and Technology (KAUST)

Thuwal, KSA

MSc ELECTRICAL & COMPUTER ENGINEERING, AI SYSTEMS TRACK

2016 – 2017

King Fahd University of Petroleum & Minerals (KFUPM)

Dhahran, KSA

BSc ELECTRICAL ENGINEERING, FIRST HONORS, GPA 4.00/4.00

2012 – 2016

Publications

1. **Tarek Mahmoud**, Veronika Solopova, ..., and Preslav Nakov. “[Uncovering Temporal Framing in the News](#)”. In *Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2026*. (Top 15%, Oral Presentation, SAC Highlights Award)
2. Yuxia Wang, Ruoyu Xing, ..., and **Tarek Mahmoud**, ..., and Preslav Nakov. “[Is Human-Like Text Liked by Humans? Multilingual Human Detection and Preference Against AI](#)”. In *Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2026*. (Oral Presentation)
3. **Tarek Mahmoud**. “[Modeling Persuasion in Language](#)”. *PhD Dissertation, MBZUAI, 2026*.
4. Jakub Piskorski, **Tarek Mahmoud**, Nikolaos Nikolaidis, Ricardo Campos, Alípio Mário Jorge, Dimitar Dimitrov, ..., and Preslav Nakov. “[SemEval 2025 Task 10: Multilingual Characterization and Extraction of Narratives from Online News](#)”. In *Proceedings of the 19th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation: SemEval 2025*.
5. **Tarek Mahmoud**, Zhuohan Xie, Dimitar Iliyanov Dimitrov, Nikolaos Nikolaidis, Purificação Silvano, Roman Yangarber, ..., and Preslav Nakov. “[Entity Framing and Role Portrayal in the News](#)”. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2025*.
6. Yuxia Wang, Artem Shelmanov, ..., **Tarek Mahmoud**, ..., and Preslav Nakov. “[GenAI Content Detection Task 1: English and Multilingual Machine-Generated Text Detection: AI vs. Human](#)”. In *Proceedings of the 1st Workshop on GenAI Content Detection: GenAIDetect 2025*.

7. Artur Muratov, Hana Fatima Shaikh, Vanshikaa Jani, **Tarek Mahmoud**, ..., and Preslav Nakov. “FRaN-X: FRaming and Narratives-eXplorer”. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2507.06974*, 2025.
8. **Tarek Mahmoud**, Zhuohan Xie, and Preslav Nakov. “BERTastic at SemEval-2025 Task 10: State-of-the-Art Accuracy in Coarse-Grained Entity Framing for Hindi News”. In *Proceedings of the 19th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation: SemEval 2025*.
9. Yuxia Wang, Jonibek Mansurov, ..., **Tarek Mahmoud**, ..., and Preslav Nakov. “M4: Multi-Generator, Multi-Domain, and Multi-Lingual Black-Box Machine-Generated Text Detection”. In *Proceedings of the 18th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EACL 2024. (Best Resource Paper Award)*
10. Yuxia Wang, Jonibek Mansurov, ..., **Tarek Mahmoud**, ..., and Preslav Nakov. “SemEval-2024 Task 8: Multidomain, Multimodel and Multilingual Machine-Generated Text Detection”. In *Proceedings of the 18th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation: SemEval 2024*.
11. Yuxia Wang, Jonibek Mansurov, Petar Ivanov, ..., **Tarek Mahmoud**, ..., and Preslav Nakov. “M4GT-Bench: Evaluation Benchmark for Black-Box Machine-Generated Text Detection”. In *Proceedings of the 62nd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2024*.
12. Mervat Abassy, Kareem Elozeiri, ..., **Tarek Mahmoud**, ..., and Preslav Nakov. “LLM-DetectAlve: A Tool for Fine-Grained Machine-Generated Text Detection”. In *Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing: EMNLP 2024. (Demo)*
13. Ahmed Sajwani, Ahmed El Setohy, Ahmed Mekky, ..., **Tarek Mahmoud**, ..., and Preslav Nakov. “FRAPPE: FRaming, Persuasion, and Propaganda Explorer”. In *Proceedings of the 18th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EACL 2024. (Demo)*
14. **Tarek Mahmoud**, and Preslav Nakov. “BERTastic at SemEval-2024 Task 4: State-of-the-Art Multilingual Propaganda Detection in Memes via Zero-Shot Learning with Vision-Language Models”. In *Proceedings of the 18th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation: SemEval 2024*.
15. **Tarek Mahmoud**, and Preslav Nakov. “BERTastic at SemEval-2023 Task 3: Fine-Tuning Pretrained Multilingual Transformers – Does Order Matter?”. In *Proceedings of the 17th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation: SemEval 2023*.

Patents

- 2017 **Water Tank Notifier**: US Patent 9,593,977 B2
- 2014 **Qibla Orientation Device**: US Patent 8,898,012 B2

Awards & Honors

- 2026 **ACL 2026 Oral Presentation & SAC Highlights Award**: “Uncovering Temporal Framing in the News” (Top 15%)
- 2024 **Best Resource Paper Award**: EACL 2024
- 2022–2023 **MBZUAI Executive Program**: nominated to facilitate AI and innovation workshops for HE-level government officials and C-level executives
- 2022–2026 **Merit-Based Full Fellowship**: MBZUAI
- 2022 **Smart Entrepreneur Award**: Eureka Innovation Lab, Presight
- 2019 **Best Air Team Award & ERL GSA Special Prize**: European Robotics League, Spain
- 2016–2019 **Merit-Based Full Fellowship**: KAUST

- 2016 **First Honors:** Electrical Engineering, GPA 4.00/4.00, KFUPM
- 2012–2016 **Merit-Based Full Scholarship:** KFUPM

Professional Service

- 2024–2025 **Workshop Organizer:** SemEval 2025 Task 10 (Multilingual Narrative Extraction), GenAIDetect 2025 Task 1 (AI vs. Human Text Detection), SemEval 2024 Task 8 (Machine-Generated Text Detection)
- 2022–present **Reviewer:** ACL, EMNLP, NAACL, EACL, SemEval